

Brainstorming – Idea Generation & Prioritization

Project: Employee Software Installation Request (ServiceNow)

1. Background

Employees across the organization frequently need licensed software (e.g., Microsoft Office, Adobe Photoshop, AutoCAD) installed on their work devices. Today this is typically requested informally via email or verbal request to IT, resulting in delays, lost requests, no visibility into license availability, and inconsistent approval oversight from managers.

2. Brainstorming Session Goal

Generate and evaluate potential approaches to digitize and automate the software installation request lifecycle — from request submission through manager approval to IT fulfillment — using the ServiceNow platform.

3. Ideas Generated

Idea	Description
Email-based request tracking	Continue using email but add a shared tracker (Excel/SharePoint) for visibility.
Standalone helpdesk ticket	Log every request as a generic IT ticket/incident with no structured approval flow.
ServiceNow Service Catalog item	Build a dedicated catalog item capturing software name, version, justification, device, license type and required-by date; route through manager approval automatically.
Chatbot-driven request	Let employees request software via a chat interface that files the request behind the scenes.
Self-service software portal with license tracking	Full catalog item + automated approval + license-availability check + auto-generated incident if licenses run out.

4. Prioritization (Impact vs. Effort)

Idea	Impact	Effort	Priority
Email + shared tracker	Low	Low	Not selected
Generic IT ticket	Medium	Low	Not selected
ServiceNow Catalog Item + Approval Flow	High	Medium	Selected ✓
Chatbot-driven request	Medium	High	Future enhancement
Full portal + license tracking	High	High	Phase 2 goal

5. Selected Approach

Build a ServiceNow Service Catalog item for software installation requests, backed by a data-driven workflow: Catalog Item → Requested Item → Manager Approval → Fulfillment Task, with an automated Incident raised if a request cannot be fulfilled due to license shortage.

6. Why This Approach Was Prioritized

- Uses ServiceNow's native Service Catalog and Approval engine — no external tools needed.
- Gives employees a simple, guided form instead of ad-hoc emails.
- Gives managers a single, familiar place (My Approvals) to review and decide.
- Gives IT/Network teams a trackable fulfillment task instead of a buried email.
- Effort is moderate and achievable within the project timeline, while still demonstrating a complete real-world workflow.